

Διαλέξεις

Dialexeis on Good and Evil

eul_aid: cje

Period: Κλασική [Classical](#)
Dialect: Δωρίς λογοτεχνική [Literary Doric](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)
Affiliation: [Sophist](#)

The Dialexeis, also commonly known as the Dissoi Logoi, is an anonymous philosophical text from the late Classical period of ancient Greece. It was likely composed in the late 5th or early 4th century BCE, based on its style and content. The author is completely unknown, and no biographical details survive.

The work is a primary example of Sophistic literature, written in a style that reflects the methods taught by the professional educators and rhetoricians known as the Sophists. The treatise is a short, surviving work that systematically presents opposing arguments on a series of important topics. These include debates on good and bad, just and unjust, true and false, and whether virtue can be taught. This structure demonstrates the core Sophistic practice of "antilogic"—the technique of arguing both sides of a question, which was a fundamental exercise in rhetorical training.

The historical importance of the Dialexeis lies in its status as a rare, surviving example of a direct Sophistic teaching text. It provides valuable insight into the practical methods of the movement, complementing the more famous fragments of thinkers like Protagoras and Gorgias. The text also includes an early discussion on the nature of the mind, making it a document of interest for the history of psychology and epistemology. The work survives in a single manuscript, preserving a direct window into the competitive, relativistic style of argument that characterized Sophistic thought.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα · On Good and Evil](#) · 11 passages

Other Sophist Authors

- [Ἀχιλλεὺς ὁ Τατίος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Achilles Tati of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- [Κλαύδιος Αἰλιανός · Aelian of Praeneste](#) · 4 works
- [Πόπλιος Αἴλιος Ἀριστείδης Θεόδωρος · Aelius Aristides of Smyrna](#) · 3 works
- [Αἴλιος Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀλικαρνασσεύς · Aelius Dionysius of Halicarnassus](#) · 1 work
- [Αἴλιος Θέων ὁ σοφιστής · Aelius Theon the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλκιδάμας ὁ Ἐλαεύς · Alcidas of Elaea](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλκίφρων ὁ Σοφιστής · Alciphron the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ τοῦ Νουμήνιου · Alexander Son of Numenius](#) · 2 works

- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Alexander the Ephesian Poet · 1 work
- Ἀμφικράτης Ἀθηναῖος · Amphicrates Atheniensis · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς Ἀφθόνιον · Anonymous Commentary on Aphthonius · 2 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antiphon of Athens · 9 works